

5. DO remember cooling requirements and power supply requirements when upgrading. These are things you may not have factored in. If you're upgrading to a much faster processor, for example, your current cabinet and cooling system may have to be overhauled as well.
6. DON'T rack hard drives on top of each other, cramp up the space with wires, etc. Buy a bigger cabinet if need be.
7. DON'T do a mismatched upgrade—for example, too much RAM for a relatively slow processor, etc. You'll need some research to come up with a balanced system configuration.
8. DO keep ergonomics in mind when upgrading keyboards, mice and any other input devices. This is very important. It also depends on how often you use your computer. And it also depends on what kind of chair and table or desk you'll be using. If need be, simulate your seating arrangement when you're purchasing, say, a new keyboard, to see if you're comfortable. Also, consider something like the Natural Keyboard from Microsoft.
9. DON'T rush in for something that strikes your fancy. For example, Zip drives in their heyday were attractive, but they soon fizzled out because CD-Writers were just round the corner. Those who didn't consider all their options were left with poky 100 MB drives, while those who did were up-to-date—with 650 MB media drives. This is a lesson from the past well worth remembering.
10. DO balance your budget. Do you need more RAM, or a larger monitor? Do you need a larger hard disk, or a better cabinet and power supply? It may seem odd to compare such diverse components, but unless money is no concern, you'll need to look hard and see what exactly you want to upgrade, and what you can do within your budget.